

# Hazlitt Fellowship — Cover Letter

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Dear Hazlitt Fellowship Selection Committee,

I am applying to the Hazlitt Fellowship because the strongest case for liberty is sitting untouched in the sciences — and I want to be the one who puts it on camera and on paper.

I just graduated from UC Santa Cruz with a degree in bioinformatics. My undergraduate research proved what I had already suspected: living systems operate by the same principles the Austrian economists described. Mises argued that without prices, a central planner cannot rationally allocate resources. The cell has been proving him right for four billion years — each enzyme pricing its substrate through binding affinity, ATP emerging as universal biological currency the same way money emerges in Menger's theory, not by decree but because it was the most exchangeable energy carrier. In simulation, distributed metabolic allocation retains 71% of output under stress. Centralized allocation retains 53%. The *E. coli* gene regulatory network tolerates removal of 37% of its nodes before fragmenting. A centralized network collapses at 2%. That is a 19-to-1 robustness ratio in favor of the architecture the liberty movement has been defending in political language for decades.

This is not ideology projected onto nature. This is nature revealing the principle.

I have spent the past year building the Living Age — a project with two arms. The first is media: a trilogy of books connecting Austrian economics, molecular biology, and the philosophy of conscience. The trilogy spans 126 chapters across three volumes. I have written and organized all of them — from "The Bones of Joseph," which maps the Mises calculation problem onto cellular metabolism, to "The Triangle That Cannot Be Divided," which argues that creating, thinking, and protecting must live whole in one person. The second arm is technology: LivingWorks, a genome design system I am developing that treats biological engineering as stewardship of living order rather than industrial control. My capstone paper, "The Living Architecture," formalizes this framework and has been submitted for publication to *Frontiers in Systems Biology*.

I am also the California State Director for Students For Liberty, where I have organized campus events, built outreach pipelines, and developed an impact project proposal that connects STEM students to the philosophy of liberty through biology rather than politics. I presented this thesis at SynBioBeta — the largest synthetic biology conference in North America — and at FEE Summer Campus, where I met Anthony Rosario and shared my capstone paper.

What attracts me to the Hazlitt Fellowship specifically is the emphasis on communication. I have the research, the writing, and the cross-disciplinary framework. What I want to sharpen is the craft of making these ideas reach people who would never read an economics paper but who already understand, from their own training, that life is not a machine. Every biology student knows that centralized control in the body is called cancer. Every ecology student knows that monoculture plantations collapse while diverse forests endure. They already think in systems — they just need someone to show them that the system they study every day is the system Hayek and Mises were describing.

I am the grandson of Art Clokey, the creator of Gumby. My grandfather showed the world that clay could come alive. My father, Joe Clokey, carried that creative mission through an industry that tried to reduce living art to a product — and it cost him everything. Three generations. Three encounters with the same architecture of control. And three refusals to comply. The bones returned to dust. The promise did not. That promise is the Living Age — and the Hazlitt Fellowship is where I want to learn to carry it further.

I can commit 8-10 hours weekly and attend the November summit. I look forward to the opportunity to bring biology into the conversation about liberty.

Respectfully,

Sage Clokey